Digital Marketing – Unit Notes

GTU Diploma in Information Technology – Semester 3

Course Code: DI03016011 | Academic Year: 2024-25

UNIT 1 – Introduction to Digital Marketing

1.1 Fundamentals of Digital Marketing

Definition: Digital marketing is the promotion of products, services, or brands using digital channels such as websites, search engines, social media, email, and online advertising.

Uses:

- Promotes products and services online.
- Reaches selected target audiences.
- Measures campaign performance using digital data.

Features:

- Internet-based.
- Targeted communication.
- Measurable results.

Application: Businesses use websites, social media, search engines, and email to communicate with customers.

Real-life Example: A clothing store promotes a new collection through Instagram and its website.

1.2 Evolution and Growth of Digital Marketing

Definition: The evolution of digital marketing describes how marketing changed from basic websites and email to social media, mobile marketing, AI, and automation.

Uses:

- Explains major milestones.
- Shows the effect of mobile technology.
- Introduces AI and automation in marketing.

Features:

- Technology-driven.
- Continuously changing.
- Uses automated and intelligent tools.

Application: Companies use mobile apps, AI chatbots, personalized recommendations, and automated campaigns.

Real-life Example: An online shopping website recommends products based on a customer's activity.

1.3 P.O.E.M. Framework

Definition: P.O.E.M. is a digital marketing framework consisting of Paid, Owned, and Earned Media.

Uses:

- Classifies marketing channels.
- Helps plan campaigns.
- Shows how different media work together.

Features:

- Paid media uses advertising.
- Owned media is controlled by the brand.
- Earned media comes from customers or others.

Application: A company combines advertisements, its website, and customer reviews in one campaign.

Real-life Example: A brand runs paid Instagram ads, publishes articles on its website, and receives customer shares.

1.4 Digital Marketing Planning & Execution

Definition: Digital marketing planning is the process of deciding the target audience, objectives, channels, activities, budget, and methods for measuring success.

Uses:

- Identifies target customers.
- Sets campaign objectives.
- Measures campaign results.

Features:

- Goal-oriented.
- Audience-focused.
- Data-driven.

Application: A business researches customers, selects suitable channels, creates content, launches the campaign, and measures results.

Real-life Example: A bakery targets local customers with Instagram posts and measures enquiries and orders.

1.5 Latest Trends in Digital Marketing

Definition: Digital marketing trends are new technologies and methods that influence how businesses communicate with online audiences.

Uses:

- Uses AI-powered marketing.
- Supports voice and conversational search.
- Uses short-form video and immersive experiences.

Features:

- Technology-based.
- Customer-focused.
- Changes rapidly.

Application: Businesses use chatbots, personalized recommendations, Reels, Shorts, voice search, AR/VR, and featured snippets.

Real-life Example: A brand uses an AI chatbot to answer customer questions automatically.

1.6 Ethical Considerations & Data Privacy

Definition: Ethical digital marketing means promoting products honestly and handling customer data responsibly according to applicable privacy rules.

Uses:

- Protects customer information.

- Supports consent-based marketing.
- Encourages responsible data collection.

Features:

- Privacy-focused.
- Consent-based.
- Transparent.

Application: Businesses use first-party data and privacy-conscious tracking while following laws such as GDPR, CCPA, and India's DPDP Act.

Real-life Example: A website asks users for consent before using certain tracking technologies.

UNIT 2 – Introduction to Search Engine Optimization (SEO)

2.1 Introduction to SEO

Definition: SEO is the process of improving a website so that it can appear more prominently in search engine results.

Uses:

- Improves website visibility.
- Helps attract relevant visitors.
- Supports organic search traffic.

Features:

- Search-focused.
- Organic.
- Requires continuous optimization.

Application: Businesses optimize website content, structure, and technical elements for search engines.

Real-life Example: A college website optimizes pages for searches related to its courses.

2.2 SEO Methods and Tactics

Definition: SEO methods are approaches used to improve search visibility, commonly classified as White Hat SEO and Black Hat SEO.

Uses:

- Identifies acceptable SEO practices.
- Explains risky manipulation techniques.
- Helps select suitable SEO tactics.

Features:

- White Hat follows search-engine guidelines.
- Black Hat attempts manipulation.
- Methods affect website ranking.

Application: A website uses useful content and proper optimization rather than deceptive techniques.

Real-life Example: Creating helpful original content is a White Hat SEO practice.

2.3 SEO Optimization Techniques

Definition: SEO optimization techniques improve different parts of a website through on-page, off-page, and technical SEO.

Uses:

- Improves page content.
- Builds external authority and links.
- Improves technical website performance.

Features:

- On-page focuses on website content.
- Off-page focuses on external signals.
- Technical SEO focuses on website structure and performance.

Application: A business improves title tags, content, backlinks, mobile usability, and technical performance.

Real-life Example: An online store improves product titles, descriptions, mobile speed, and backlinks.

2.4 Search Engine Ranking

Definition: SEO ranking is the position of a webpage in search engine results for a particular search query.

Uses:

- Helps measure search visibility.
- Identifies ranking factors.
- Guides optimization work.

Features:

- Query-dependent.
- Influenced by multiple factors.
- Can change over time.

Application: Websites improve useful content, relevance, technical quality, and other ranking factors.

Real-life Example: A website improves its page content and loading speed to compete for a search result.

2.5 Role of Social Media in SEO

Definition: Social media can support SEO by increasing content visibility, engagement, sharing, and opportunities for people to discover a website.

Uses:

- Increases content exposure.
- Can bring visitors to websites.
- Supports brand awareness.

Features:

- Socially distributed.
- Engagement-oriented.
- Supports content discovery.

Application: Businesses share useful website content through social platforms.

Real-life Example: A company shares a blog post on social media and receives visitors from the shared content.

UNIT 3 – Introduction to Web Analytics

3.1 Data Collection, Weblogs, Page Tagging & Key Metrics

Definition: Web analytics collects and measures website data to understand visitor activity and website performance.

Uses:

- Measures visitors and pageviews.
- Studies visitor behavior.
- Helps evaluate website performance.

Features:

- Data-based.
- Metric-driven.
- Tracks user activity.

Application: Businesses monitor unique visitors, pageviews, pages/visit, average visit duration, bounce rate, and new visits.

Real-life Example: An online store checks pageviews and bounce rate to understand website behavior.

3.2 Types of Web Analytics Tools

Definition: Web analytics tools are software tools used to measure different aspects of websites, customers, usability, SEO, products, and business performance.

Uses:

- Analyzes website content.
- Studies customer behavior.
- Tests usability and SEO.

Features:

- Purpose-specific.
- Data-driven.
- Can include open-source and enterprise tools.

Application: Organizations select tools according to their analytics requirements.

Real-life Example: A company uses an SEO analytics tool to monitor search performance.

3.3 Goals and Conversion Rate in GA4

Definition: A goal represents an important action a user should complete, while conversion rate measures how effectively visitors complete a desired action.

Uses:

- Measures important actions.
- Tracks conversions.
- Helps improve website performance.

Features:

- Action-oriented.
- Measurable.
- Useful for performance analysis.

Application: A business tracks actions such as purchases, registrations, or enquiries in analytics.

Real-life Example: An online store measures how many visitors complete a purchase.

3.4 Multi-touch Attribution Models

Definition: Multi-touch attribution assigns conversion credit across multiple interactions that a customer has with marketing channels before conversion.

Uses:

- Measures customer touchpoints.
- Helps understand channel contribution.
- Supports campaign evaluation.

Features:

- Uses multiple touchpoints.
- Includes models such as Linear and Time Decay.
- Supports data-based decisions.

Application: A business compares how search, social media, and email contributed to a conversion.

Real-life Example: A customer sees an ad, later searches the brand, receives an email, and then purchases.

3.5 Google Tag Manager

Definition: Google Tag Manager is a tool used to manage and deploy website or app tracking tags without repeatedly changing website code.

Uses:

- Manages tracking tags.
- Supports analytics implementation.
- Helps organize marketing tags.

Features:

- Tag-based.
- Centralized management.
- Supports tracking implementation.

Application: A website team uses Tag Manager to deploy analytics and advertising tags.

Real-life Example: A marketing team adds an analytics tag through Google Tag Manager.

UNIT 4 – Introduction to Social Media Marketing

4.1 Introduction to Social Media Marketing

Definition: Social media marketing is the use of social networking platforms to promote products, services, brands, and content.

Uses:

- Promotes brands.
- Engages audiences.
- Supports customer communication.

Features:

- Interactive.
- Audience-focused.
- Content-driven.

Application: Businesses create posts, campaigns, and other social content for target audiences.

Real-life Example: A restaurant posts food videos and offers on social media.

4.2 Meta Platform Marketing

Definition: Meta platform marketing uses Meta's social platforms and advertising tools to promote products and communicate with audiences.

Uses:

- Runs social advertisements.
- Generates leads.
- Measures campaign insights.

Features:

- Supports multiple ad formats.
- Targeted.
- Analytics-supported.

Application: Businesses use Carousel, Story, Lead Generation, and Video Ads and review Insights in Meta Business Suite.

Real-life Example: A business runs a lead-generation ad to collect customer enquiries.

4.3 Twitter (X) for Business

Definition: Twitter (X) for business uses posts, hashtags, customer service, live updates, and advertising to communicate with customers.

Uses:

- Promotes business content.
- Provides customer service.
- Supports live updates and advertising.

Features:

- Real-time communication.
- Hashtag-based discovery.
- Advertising support.

Application: Companies use hashtags, promoted tweets, promoted accounts, trends, and customer interactions.

Real-life Example: A company uses a hashtag during a product launch and responds to customer questions.

4.4 Video Marketing

Definition: Video marketing is the use of videos to communicate product, brand, educational, or promotional messages to an audience.

Uses:

- Explains products.
- Educates customers.
- Builds brand engagement.

Features:

- Visual.
- Engaging.
- Supports many formats.

Application: Businesses create explainer, educational, animation, brand, testimonial, demo, 360°, and AR videos.

Real-life Example: A software company creates a short demo video showing how its product works.

UNIT 5 – Digital Promotions

5.1 Email Marketing

Definition: Email marketing is the use of email messages to communicate promotional or useful information to customers and audiences.

Uses:

- Promotes products and services.
- Maintains customer communication.
- Measures campaign performance.

Features:

- Direct communication.
- Measurable.
- Campaign-based.

Application: Businesses create campaigns and measure open rate, CTR, unsubscribe rate, delivery rate, and bounce rate.

Real-life Example: A bakery sends an email announcing its seasonal menu and checks the campaign CTR.

5.2 Search Engine Marketing (SEM)

Definition: SEM is the promotion of websites or products through paid search and other online advertising methods.

Uses:

- Increases online visibility.
- Targets selected audiences.
- Measures advertising performance.

Features:

- Paid promotion.
- Keyword and audience targeting.
- Performance measurement.

Application: Businesses use Search, Display, Shopping, Video, Local Service, App, and Social Media Ads.

Real-life Example: A travel agency runs a paid search advertisement for vacation packages.

Suggested Practical Outcomes

1. Analyze a well-known brand's Paid, Owned, and Earned Media.
2. Create a SERP snippet with a title tag, meta description, and SEO-friendly product description.
3. Audit two business websites for On-Page and Off-Page SEO factors.
4. Test website page speed and mobile-friendliness.
5. Create a single-page Google website for an online product.
6. Connect the website with Google Analytics and prepare an analytics matrix.
7. Design social media infographics, ads, covers, and posts.
8. Create and share an engaging product video on social media.
9. Upload the video to YouTube and observe channel analytics.
10. Create an email marketing campaign and analyze Open Rate, CTR, and Bounce Rate.
11. Create a mock Google Search Ad for a travel agency.